MODULE 25 · SECTION 4 - BUSINESS STRATEGIES FOR A SUCCESSFUL GEN AI SOLUTION

Leading adoption: strategy, roles, change and impact

Top-down support with bottom-up ideas, who does what, how to bring people with you, and how to tell whether adoption is working.

SECTION 4 of 4 EXAM WEIGHT ~15% MODULE 25 of 33

admin@sthithapragna.com

"**Bottom-up culture, top-down support.**" Ideas come from the people who do the work; backing comes from the top.

Top-down alone, or bottom-up alone?

TOP-DOWN ONLY

A mandate from the board

- Clear priorities and funding
- But ideas miss real workflows
- Staff comply, then drift away
- "AI everywhere" with little use

BOTTOM-UP ONLY

Enthusiasts on their own

- Real, practical ideas
- But no budget or priority
- Duplicated tools, uneven risk
- Pilots that never scale

THE TIEBREAKER

Combine them: leaders set direction, fund and govern; teams find and test the use cases. That is Google's recommended approach.

Who does what in AI adoption

ROLE	THEIR JOB
Executives	Sponsor, fund, set priorities and governance
Mid-level managers	Find high-impact, feasible use cases in their workflows
Practitioners	Experiment, give feedback, become champions
IT, security, legal	Approved platforms, guardrails, data rules
Data and AI team	Build, evaluate and run the solutions

ON THE EXAM

Mid-level managers know the workflows and own the KPIs. Questions about finding practical use cases usually point to them.

AI champions: the colleague next door

- **Google's advice:** "the best influencer is a coworker people know and trust."
- **Recruit volunteers** from every business unit, including executives.
- **Champions show** real examples, answer questions and share tips.
- **Support them:** training, office hours, a shared chat space, recognition.
- **Keep going after the pilot;** adoption is a process, not a destination.

> THE SIGNAL
>
> Uneven adoption across teams: build a champion network. Peers spread practical habits faster than memos.

Bringing people with you

- **Name the fear:** many staff worry AI will replace them.
- **Explain the purpose:** which tasks change, and what people gain.
- **Involve people early** in choosing and testing use cases.
- **Show quick wins,** from colleagues, in their own work.
- **Redesign the workflow,** not just add a tool to the old one.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> Low adoption with fear or mistrust: communicate, involve and train. Mandates and monitoring make resistance worse.

Skills for every level

GROUP	WHAT THEY NEED TO LEARN
Everyone	AI literacy, safe use, good prompting
Managers	Spotting use cases, measuring impact
Leaders	Strategy, risk and responsible AI
Builders	Platforms, grounding, evaluation

REMEMBER

Training is not a one-off launch event. New features and new staff mean it must continue.

Build, buy or customise?

CHOICE	WHEN IT FITS
Buy	A common need, available today: meeting notes, email help
Customise	Your data or workflows matter: grounded agents, search
Build	A unique differentiator, and you have the skills

THE TIEBREAKER

Buy what is common, customise what is yours, build only what makes you different.

Guardrails, not gates

GATES

Everything needs approval

- Slow sign-off for every idea
- Staff route around the rules
- Shadow AI in free tools
- Risk rises, not falls

GUARDRAILS

Safe by default

- Approved tools for everyday use
- Clear rules on data and use
- Light review for low risk
- Deeper review for high stakes

THE TAKEAWAY

Make the safe path the easy path. Wrenfield's quirk 6 happened because the approved option did not exist yet.

From pilot to the way we work

01
Pilot
One team, a baseline, a decision date.

02
Prove
Measure against the baseline.

03
Scale
More teams, with champions and training.

04
Embed
Redesign the workflow; make it standard.

05
Improve
Monitor, gather feedback, refine.

REMEMBER

Many AI projects stall between prove and scale. Sponsorship, champions and training are what carry them across.

Is adoption actually working?

MEASURE	EXAMPLE AT WRENFIELD
Usage	Weekly active users, not licences bought
Efficiency	Minutes saved per description or per call
Quality	Errors, rework, customer complaints
Experience	Staff and customer satisfaction
Business result	Cost per contact, conversion, revenue

THE TIEBREAKER

Licences bought and prompts typed are activity, not impact. Measure use, outcomes and results against the baseline.

Wrenfield's adoption plan

WHO	ROLE IN THE PLAN
Chief executive	Sponsor: sets priorities and funds them
Finance director	Owns baselines and the ROI review
Security chief	Approved tools and data rules: guardrails
118 store managers	Bottom-up use cases from the shop floor
Champions	One per region, plus head office teams

THE TAKEAWAY

"AI in every department" becomes a plan: top-down support, bottom-up ideas, guardrails and champions.

> Wrenfield's board mandated that every department adopt AI this quarter, without asking teams what they need.
>
> Three months later, licences are bought but usage is low and few workflows have changed.

What should leadership do?

A Set tougher usage targets and monitor compliance

B Buy more licences and more tools

C Let each team adopt any tool it likes, with no coordination

D Keep executive sponsorship, and have teams identify the use cases in their own work

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should leadership do?

A Set tougher usage targets and monitor compliance

More mandate, same disconnect.

B Buy more licences and more tools

More technology, same lack of use cases.

C Let each team adopt any tool it likes, with no coordination

Bottom-up alone: duplication and uneven risk.

D Keep executive sponsorship, and have teams identify the use cases in their own work

Top-down support with bottom-up ideas.

THE TAKEAWAY

Bottom-up culture, top-down support: combine them.

> Wrenfield wants a shortlist of high-impact, feasible use cases drawn from real daily workflows in stores, warehouses and the contact centre.

Who is best placed to identify them?

A The chief executive

B Mid-level managers who run those workflows

C An external vendor's sales team

D The IT help desk

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Who is best placed to identify them?

A The chief executive

Sets direction, but is far from daily work.

B Mid-level managers who run those workflows

Know the work and own the KPIs.

C An external vendor's sales team

Sells products, not your workflows.

D The IT help desk

Fixes problems, does not own workflows.

THE SIGNAL

Practical use cases inside workflows: mid-level managers.

> After Gemini rolls out to head office, many staff avoid it.
>
> In surveys they say they fear AI will make their roles redundant, and they do not trust its answers.

What should the leader do first?

A Explain the purpose, involve staff in use cases, train them, and share colleagues' quick wins

B Ban discussion of job impacts

C Make usage mandatory and track it per person

D Wait until the fears fade by themselves

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the leader do first?

A Explain the purpose, involve staff in use cases, train them, and share colleagues' quick wins

Addresses fear and trust directly.

B Ban discussion of job impacts

Silence feeds the fear.

C Make usage mandatory and track it per person

Monitoring deepens resistance.

D Wait until the fears fade by themselves

Fears rarely fade unaddressed.

THE SIGNAL

Fear and mistrust: communicate, involve and train.

> Gemini is available to all Wrenfield head office teams.
>
> Some teams use it daily and save hours; others barely touch it.

What is the most effective way to spread the good habits?

A. A single mandatory e-learning course

B. An email from IT announcing the features again

C. A network of champions from each team, with support and recognition

D. Buy a different AI tool

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most effective way to spread the good habits?

A A single mandatory e-learning course
One-off, and not tied to real work.

B An email from IT announcing the features again
Already tried, in effect.

C A network of champions from each team, with support and recognition
Trusted peers share practical examples.

D Buy a different AI tool
The tool is not the problem.

THE SIGNAL

Uneven adoption: a champion network spreads habits peer to peer.

> Wrenfield wants a room-planning experience that combines its own catalogue, customers' room scans and its delivery rules.
>
> Leaders see it as a key competitive difference, and Wrenfield has developers to build and run it.

Which approach fits best?

A Use the Gemini app as it is

B Train a new foundation model from scratch

C Wait for a vendor to sell one

D Build on Agent Platform, grounded in Wrenfield's own data and rules

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which approach fits best?

A Use the Gemini app as it is

Generic; it cannot use Wrenfield's data or rules.

B Train a new foundation model from scratch

The top rung; vast cost for no gain.

C Wait for a vendor to sell one

A differentiator cannot be bought off the shelf.

D Build on Agent Platform, grounded in Wrenfield's own data and rules

A unique differentiator, built on a platform, with the skills in house.

THE SIGNAL

A unique differentiator, with the skills: build on a platform, not from scratch.

> Six months after rollout, Wrenfield has bought Gemini licences for all 2,100 head office staff.
>
> The finance director asks whether adoption is working.

Which evidence answers her best?

A The number of licences purchased

B Weekly active users, plus time saved on target tasks against the baseline

C The total number of prompts typed

D A vendor benchmark score

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which evidence answers her best?

A The number of licences purchased

Spending, not use.

B Weekly active users, plus time saved on target tasks against the baseline

Real use and real outcomes, compared with before.

C The total number of prompts typed

Activity, not impact.

D A vendor benchmark score

Says nothing about Wrenfield's staff.

THE SIGNAL

Licences and prompts are activity. Measure use and outcomes against a baseline.

Module 25 in five lines

- Bottom-up culture, top-down support: combine both.
- Executives sponsor and govern; managers find use cases; practitioners experiment.
- Champions, honest communication and training beat mandates.
- Buy what is common, customise what is yours, build what makes you different.
- Measure use and outcomes, not licences or prompts.